

tional source of electricity or power, that your home or office generates its own renewable power through green initiatives. Back in 2006, USA Today reported that close to 200,000 American families were living off-the-grid. Since then, the trend has attracted steady global interest, and there's a Bollywood actress who recently converted her home to off-the-grid. Gul Panag destroyed her ancestral home to create fully modern, green, self-contained house that generates its own electricity and conducts rain-water harvesting. For anyone interested in going the green way for their household, they can approach GRIHA or Green Rating for Integrated Habitat Assessment (<http://www.grihindia.org/>), the national rating system in India.

What's happening in India

India being a lucrative market in the energy sector, a lot is happening in India as far as green initiatives go. As you may know, the Indian government has also set itself the target of producing a minimum of 22 gigawatts or 22,000 megawatts of solar power by 2022 -- the maximum target is to reach 72 gigawatts of solar power by that time. An ambitious target, but one that many industry watchdogs and experts think the country will achieve. Let's take a closer look at some initiatives that are setting the tone for this new green revolution.

Gujarat's canal-top solar power project

In a moment of great national and state pride, Narendra Modi, chief minister of the state of Gujarat allowed himself a smile, as he stood amidst endless rows of solar panels. The occasion to celebrate was the inauguration of the world's first canal-top solar power project built on one of the branches of the Narmada river canal network. This ambitious project, first of its kind in the world, would add 1 MW of power to the national grid.

Another advantage of deploying solar power projects of this kind, built or suspended over rivers or canals, is the amount of land that can be saved from solar panel fields. In the case of the Gujarat

